

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 4 3 2

♥ K Q J 8 2

♦ 2

♣ 5 3

♠ A Q

♥ T 7 4

♦ K J 6 3

♣ K Q J 7



♠ T 6 5

♥ A 9 5 3

♦ 9 4

♣ 9 8 4 2

♠ K J 7

♥ 6

♦ A Q T 8 7 5

♣ A T 6

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♦
All Pass			
6♦ by South			

Board 2
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ 7 4 3
 ♥ T 7
 ♦ A T 8 5
 ♣ J T 5 4

♠ A 6 5 2
 ♥ Q J 5 2
 ♦ K J 3
 ♣ 8 2



♠ Q J 9
 ♥ 3
 ♦ Q 9 7 6 4 2
 ♣ 9 6 3

♠ K T 8
 ♥ A K 9 8 6 4
 ♦ -
 ♣ A K Q 7

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South
 good idea so you say 6♥.

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠A or the practically useless ♦A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠A. It looks like the slam is a

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ -
♥ A 5 4 3 2
♦ Q J T 4
♣ T 5 4 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J T 7

♦ -

♣ A 9 8 3



♠ J T 3

♥ Q 9 6

♦ K 9 8 7 5

♣ 7 6

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 5 2
 ♥ 2
 ♦ T 8 6 5 4
 ♣ A 7 4 2

♠ A T 8
 ♥ K 9 8 4
 ♦ K 9
 ♣ K T 6 5



♠ 9 7 4 3
 ♥ Q J 5 3
 ♦ 7 3 2
 ♣ 8 3

♠ K Q J
 ♥ A T 7 6
 ♦ A Q J
 ♣ Q J 9

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by South			

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.